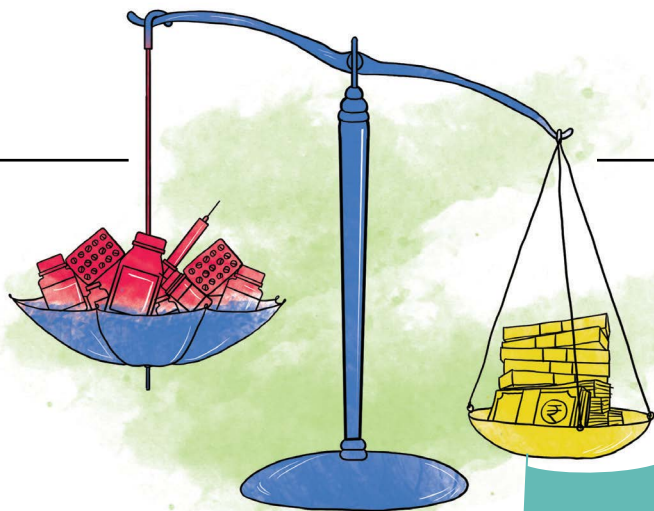




54 SET UP A HEALTH PRICING AUTHORITY

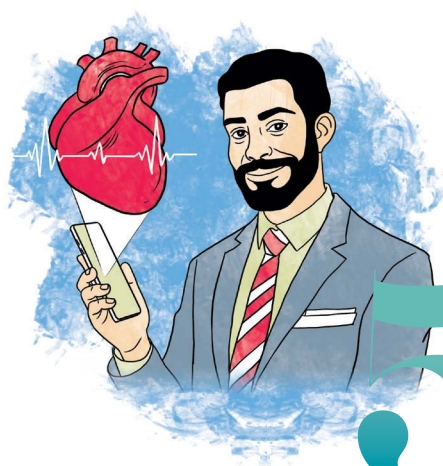
► Establish an independent Health Pricing Authority to oversee the pricing of diagnostics, procedures, and essential medicines. Modelled on the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority, it should use actuarial analysis, clinical outcomes, and cost benchmarks to set fair, inflation-adjusted reference prices. The goal is to ensure affordability for patients without compromising on quality, innovation, and sustainability of service providers.

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MANDATE CLEAR LABELING OF HEALTH PRODUCTS

► Mandate clear front-of-pack labelling and full ingredient disclosure for all health-related consumer products, including packaged food, cosmetics, dietary supplements, over-the-counter medicines, and traditional remedies like ayurvedic formulations. A unified labelling standard across regulatory bodies should be enforced to prevent conflicting rules and ensure transparency. Strict penalties must be imposed for misleading health claims, hidden additives, or non-disclosure.

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YOUR HEALTH DATA, YOUR RIGHT

► Enact a Health Data Ownership Act to legally recognise individuals as the primary owners of their health records. The law should clearly regulate how hospitals, insurers, and digital health start-ups collect, store, and share personal health data. It must mandate explicit patient consent for data use and ensure stringent digital security. Establish a dedicated authority to enforce compliance, manage grievances, and audit data practices.

MISSION SENIOR CARE

► Launch a National Geriatric Health Mission to address the unique needs of India's growing elderly population. The programme should focus on home-based medical support, age-friendly hospital infrastructure, and specialised care hubs for chronic conditions like dementia, arthritis, and cardiovascular diseases. It must include respite care services for caregivers and train healthcare workers in geriatric protocols. As India ages, the health system must evolve from acute interventions to long-term, preventive and palliative models.



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